

GHERKIN / ACCEPTANCE TEMPLATE — copy, rename, done

Given = Arrange · When = Act · Then = Assert. Graded: usually ≥ 2 Given and ≥ 2 Then per scenario, and **at least one happy path AND one failure path**. Use the words of the task for pages, buttons, messages.

Feature: <what the user can do, one line>

As a <role>

I want <goal>

So that <benefit>

Background:

Given the system is running

And <the shared setup every scenario needs, e.g. "I am on the login page">

Scenario: <happy path, one sentence>

Given <precondition 1>

And <precondition 2>

When <the ONE action the user takes>

Then <visible result 1>

And <visible result 2 or system-side effect>

Scenario: <failure path>

Given <precondition 1>

And <precondition 2>

When <the same action with bad data>

Then <error message is shown: "...">

And <nothing changed / user stays on the page / access denied>

Scenario Outline: <same steps, many data rows>

Given I am registered with username "<username>" and password "<password>"

When I log in with username "<usernameInput>" and password "<passwordInput>"

Then I see "<result>"

Examples:

username	password	usernameInput	passwordInput	result	
student	password123	student	password123	the dashboard	
student	password123	student	wrong	an error message	

Worked example (login)

Feature: Login

Scenario: Successful login with valid credentials

Given I am on the login page

And I am registered with username "student" and password "password123"

When I enter the username "student"

And I enter the password "password123"

And I click the login button

Then I am redirected to the dashboard

And I see the message "Welcome, student"

Scenario: Login fails with invalid credentials

Given I am on the login page

And I am registered with username "student" and password "password123"

When I enter the username "student"

And I enter the password "wrong"

And I click the login button

Then I see the error message "Invalid username or password"

And I remain on the login page

Rules

- One **When** per scenario (one trigger). Several **And**s after a **Given/Then** are fine.
- **Then** describes **observable** results (message, page, state), never "the database row is inserted".
- Use **And** instead of repeating **Given/Then**. Keep scenarios independent of each other.
- Repeated setup in many scenarios → **Background:** (or "Common Includes"); same logic with many data rows → **Scenario Outline** + **Examples** (or "Parameterized Includes").
- Three Amigos (domain expert, developer, tester) write scenarios **together** — developers alone is the anti-pattern.